KOREAN BEEF BULGOGI

☐ *yield:* **6 SERVINGS** ☐ *prep:* **2 HOURS 45 MINUTES** ☐ *cook:* **15 MINUTES** ☐ *total:* **3 HOURS**

This Korean beef bulgogi dish is an easy recipe for Korean BBQ with the most flavorful marinade! And the thin slices of meat cook so quickly!

⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐ *5 stars (351 ratings)*

INGREDIENTS

- **1 ½ pounds** boneless ribeye steak
- **½** small pear, *peeled and coarsely grated*
- **¼ cup** reduced sodium soy sauce
- **2 tablespoons** brown sugar
- **2 tablespoons** toasted sesame oil
- **3 cloves** garlic, *minced*
- **1 tablespoon** freshly grated ginger
- **1 tablespoon** gochujang, *Korean red pepper paste*
- **2 tablespoons** vegetable oil, *divided*
- **2** green onions, *thinly sliced*
- **1 teaspoon** toasted sesame seeds

EQUIPMENT

- Cast Iron Grill Pan
- Cast Iron Skillet

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Wrap steak in plastic wrap, and place in the freezer for 30 minutes. Unwrap and slice across the grain into 1/4-inch thick slices.

2. In a medium bowl, combine pear, soy sauce, brown sugar, sesame oil, garlic, ginger and gochujang. In a gallon size Ziploc bag, combine soy sauce mixture and steak; marinate for at least 2 hours to overnight, turning the bag occasionally.

3. Heat 1 tablespoon vegetable oil in a cast iron grill pan over medium-high heat. Working in batches, add steak to the grill pan in a single layer and cook, flipping once, until charred and cooked through, about 2-3 minutes per side. Repeat with remaining 1 tablespoon vegetable oil and steak.

4 Serve immediately, garnished with green onions and sesame seeds, if desired.

NOTES

- **Freeze the steak before slicing.** The key to bulgogi is using paper thin slices of meat. Throwing the steak in the freezer for 20-30 minutes will make it easier to slice the meat into very thin, even pieces. Pre-sliced bulgogi beef is also readily available at Korean and Japanese grocery stores.
- **Slice against the grain.** Always slice the beef perpendicular to the muscle fibers, shortening the fibers to allow for a more tender bite.
- **Pear adds maximum flavor.** Adding coarsely grated pear will not only add a subtle sweetness to the marinade, but it will also help tenderize the meat. Korean pear or Bosc pear can be used.
- **Use reduced sodium soy sauce.** Reduced sodium has less sodium and less salt without compromising flavor.
- **Watch the marinating time.** Marinate the beef for at least 2 hours but no longer than 24 hours as the natural enzymes of the pear will break down the protein too much, resulting in mushy, mealy beef.
- **Use a hot cast iron grill pan.** A heavy bottom pan, such as a cast iron grill pan, retains heat much better than a nonstick skillet, allowing for even cooking, a better sear and smoky, caramelized flavors.
- **Cook in batches.** Work in batches to properly sear the meat for maximum caramelization and smoky flavors. An overcrowded pan will unfortunately steam the beef instead.
- **Freeze as needed.** Marinated bulgogi is very freezer-friendly, great for meal prep and making weeknight meals even easier and quicker.

☐ *course:* **MAIN COURSE** ☐ *cuisine:* **KOREAN**

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